

Defining a Validation Experiment

within Lean Startup

Final Experiment Details and Metrics:

Key Hypotheses	H1: Competitive volleyball players and tournament organizers will pay a premium price and complete a preorder online for a portable, tournament-grade outdoor net system when reached through targeted digital advertising. H2: Meta (Facebook/Instagram) ads targeting volleyball audiences generate cost-effective, measurable purchase intent for Oni Nets products. H3: The Indoor Short Court system addresses a market gap — no commercial product currently exists for this use case — and will generate unsolicited inbound demand when the product is made visible to the right audience.
Experiment Details	Run a \$300–\$500 Meta ad campaign (30 days) targeting volleyball enthusiasts aged 18–40 in the US. Two ad sets: (A) Outdoor Pro — emphasizing portability and fast setup vs. existing bulky systems; (B) Indoor Short Court — emphasizing that a purpose-built system now exists. Drive traffic to oninets.com product pages with a preorder CTA. Track visits, add-to-cart events, and completed preorders via Google Analytics + GTM, both already installed on the site.
Success Metrics	≥ 3 completed preorders within 30 days $CTR \geq 1.5\%$ Cost per preorder $\leq \$150$ ≥ 50 unique product-page visits per ad set
Failure Metrics	0 preorders after \$300 spend + 200 unique visits $CTR < 0.5\%$ across both ad variants Bounce rate $> 85\%$ on product pages

Exercise

1. File Name

OniNets_ValidationExperiment

2. Business Description

Oni Nets designs and manufactures two distinct portable volleyball systems targeting unmet needs in competitive and event volleyball: 1. Outdoor Pro System: Existing outdoor volleyball systems are bulky, heavy, and time-consuming to set up. Tournament organizers and competitive players who move equipment between locations need a system that is faster to deploy, easier to transport, and meets professional performance standards. The Oni Nets Outdoor Pro addresses this through a portable, tournament-grade design built for repeated mobile use. 2. Indoor Short Court System: There is currently no widely available, purpose-built portable indoor short-court volleyball system on the market. Tournament organizers and content creators are improvising with water barrels, zip ties, and homemade supports. Volleyball media channel 'Out of System' has featured short-court volleyball using these improvised setups; viewer comments consistently ask where they can purchase a real system. Contacts connected to Team USA Volleyball have independently expressed interest in a commercial solution. Oni Nets is building the first purpose-built product for this category. Currently accepting preorders at oninets.com.

3. Value Proposition Canvas

Prompt:

Create a detailed Value Proposition Canvas for the following business idea, clearly outlining customer jobs, pains, and gains, along with corresponding products, pain relievers, and gain creators. My business idea: [see business description above]

CUSTOMER PROFILE — OUTDOOR PRO Customer Jobs: Transport and deploy tournament-grade nets across multiple venues and events; meet regulation specifications without permanent installation. Pains: Current systems are heavy, slow to set up, and not designed for frequent relocation; rental equipment is unreliable; nothing on the market is both portable and genuinely tournament-grade. Gains: Fast, repeatable setup at any location; equipment that reflects the quality of the event; reduced logistics burden.

CUSTOMER PROFILE — INDOOR SHORT COURT Customer Jobs: Run short-court volleyball formats indoors for tournaments, training, or content production; find an off-the-shelf solution rather than building one. Pains: No commercial product exists; current workarounds (water barrels, zip ties, straps) are unreliable, time-consuming to set up, and look unprofessional; demand is visible but supply is absent. Gains: A system that actually works for the format; saves hours of improvisation; professional appearance for events and video content.

VALUE PROPOSITION Products: Outdoor Pro, Indoor Short Court, Complete Bundle, Anchor Kit, Oniball, Onibag. Pain Relievers: Portable design reduces transport burden; purpose-built short-court system eliminates improvisation; tournament-spec dimensions remove compliance risk. Gain Creators: Repeatable professional setup; first commercial solution in the short-court category; all-in-one bundles reduce sourcing complexity.

4. Improved Value Proposition Canvas

The canvas above was reviewed and refined with two additions: (1) 'content creators' were added as a distinct customer segment for the Indoor Short Court system, based on evidence from the 'Out of System' channel and its viewer demand. (2) 'tournament director' was separated from 'competitive player' as a distinct buyer persona with different purchase criteria — reliability and repeatability over personal performance.

5. Generate Hypotheses

Prompt:

How can I identify and prioritize the key hypotheses to test from this Value Proposition Canvas? Which assumptions pose the highest risk, and which are most critical to the success of the business?

Highest-risk hypotheses identified: H1 — Purchase intent (Outdoor Pro): Competitive players and tournament organizers will pay a premium over commodity nets when presented with a portable, tournament-grade alternative online. H2 — Channel fit: Meta ads targeting volleyball audiences can reach buyers with sufficient intent to generate measurable preorders at a viable cost per acquisition. H3 — Latent demand (Indoor Short Court): The absence of a commercial product — not lack of interest — is the primary reason buyers have not purchased. When made visible, the Indoor Short Court system will attract inbound demand. Lower-risk assumptions (already supported by evidence): volleyball players care about equipment quality; viewer comments on 'Out of System' confirm purchase intent exists; Team USA contacts confirm institutional interest.

6. Key Hypotheses Selected

Three hypotheses selected for this experiment: • H1: Serious volleyball players and tournament organizers will pay a premium and preorder online when shown a portable, tournament-grade outdoor net system. • H2: Meta ads targeting volleyball audiences deliver cost-effective, measurable purchase intent for Oni Nets. • H3: The Indoor Short Court system will generate inbound demand when made visible — validating that the market gap, not lack of interest, is the barrier to purchase.

7. Experiment Designs

Prompt:

[H1, H2, H3 above] Design three experiments to most effectively test the hypotheses. For each experiment, include clear success metrics, failure metrics, estimated costs, and potential risk.

EXPERIMENT A — Meta Ads to Preorder Page (SELECTED) Two ad sets run simultaneously. Ad Set A targets the Outdoor Pro: messaging focuses on the failure of existing bulky systems and the need for a portable, tournament-grade alternative. Ad Set B targets the Indoor Short Court: messaging focuses on the gap ('finally a real system') rather than product features. Both drive to onients.com product pages with a preorder CTA. Targeting: volleyball interests, ages 18–40, US. Budget: \$10–15/day, 30 days. Success: ≥ 3 preorders | CTR $\geq 1.5\%$ | Cost/preorder $\leq \$150$ Failure: 0 preorders after \$300 + 200 visits | CTR $< 0.5\%$ Est. Cost: \$300–\$500 | Risk: Ad creative may not convert cold traffic; mitigated by A/B testing two copy variants per ad set. EXPERIMENT B — Outreach to Volleyball Clubs and Tournament Directors Direct outreach (Instagram DM + email) to 50 volleyball clubs, league administrators, and tournament directors. Message acknowledges the problem directly: equipment that is hard to move, slow to set up, or doesn't exist for short-court formats. Provide a link to the relevant product page. Success: ≥ 5 link clicks, ≥ 1 preorder or formal inquiry Failure: < 2 responses, 0 product-page visits from outreach links Est. Cost: \$0 (time only) | Risk: Low response rate on cold outreach. EXPERIMENT C — Content Creator and Media Seeding Reach out to 'Out of System' and similar volleyball media channels. Offer a complimentary Indoor Short Court unit in exchange for honest coverage. Monitor referral traffic and preorder volume from any resulting posts or videos. Success: ≥ 1 feature or mention, ≥ 5 referral visits, ≥ 1 preorder Failure: No response, 0 referral traffic Est. Cost: \$0–\$200 (shipping/sample) | Risk: Longer lead time; less predictable.

8. Experiment Selected

Experiment A — Meta Ads to Preorder Page — was selected as the primary experiment. It provides the strongest validation signal (completed preorder = real purchase intent with a credit card), is fully measurable within 30 days, and simultaneously tests all three key hypotheses across both product lines. Details are entered in the Final Experiment Details table at the top of this document.

9. Success and Failure Metrics

SUCCESS — ready to move forward with confidence: • ≥ 3 completed preorders within 30 days of launch • Cost per preorder $\leq \$150$ • Click-through rate $\geq 1.5\%$ on at least one ad set • ≥ 50 unique product-page visits per ad set
FAILURE — pivot hypothesis or consider killing: • 0 preorders after \$300 ad spend AND 200+ unique site visits • CTR $< 0.5\%$ across all ad variants • Bounce rate $> 85\%$ on product pages
INCONCLUSIVE — additional experimentation required: • 1–2 preorders: demand signal present but insufficient; extend campaign, test revised creative, or shift targeting before making a go/no-go decision.

10. Supporting Experiment Elements

Prompt:

Write Meta ad copy for two ad sets (Outdoor Pro and Indoor Short Court), a targeting brief, and three follow-up survey questions for non-converting visitors to the Oni Nets preorder page.

AD SET A — OUTDOOR PRO Headline: 'Your Outdoor Net Shouldn't Take 45 Minutes to Set Up' Body: Most outdoor volleyball systems are built for a backyard, not a tournament. The Oni Nets Outdoor Pro is portable, regulation-spec, and sets up in minutes. First run — preorder now. CTA: Preorder Now
AD SET B — INDOOR SHORT COURT Headline: 'The Indoor Short-Court System That Didn't Exist — Until Now' Body: If you've been using water barrels and zip ties to run short-court volleyball, you already know the problem. Oni Nets built the solution. Preorder the Indoor Short Court system — limited first run. CTA: Claim My Spot
TARGETING BRIEF: Platform: Facebook + Instagram | Ages: 18–40 | Location: United States Interests: volleyball, beach volleyball, competitive sports, sports equipment Budget: \$10–15/day | Duration: 30 days | Placements: Feed + Reels 2 copy variants per ad set (4 ads total) to identify best-performing message.
FOLLOW-UP SURVEY (retargeted to non-converting visitors): 1. What stopped you from placing a preorder today? 2. What information or assurance would make you confident enough to preorder a volleyball system from a new brand? 3. How much would you expect to pay for a portable, tournament-grade volleyball net system — and would you pay more for one purpose-built for indoor short-court?

11. Experiment Design Review

Can I definitively measure success or failure? Yes. Completed preorders are a discrete, countable event tracked through the onients.com checkout flow. Google Analytics (G-G3CRYL9ZQN) and Google Tag Manager (GTM-PHPZX2M5) are installed on every page of the site and will capture conversion events, add-to-cart actions, and traffic source data. Can I measure a change in behavior? Yes — this is strong validation. Completing a preorder requires entering a payment method, representing real purchase intent rather than stated interest or a survey response. The experiment asks the most of subjects and therefore provides the most meaningful signal. Can the experiment be improved to increase confidence if success metrics are hit? Yes: (a) Scale ad budget on the better-performing ad set to verify conversion rate holds at volume. (b) Launch Experiment B (club and director outreach) in parallel at no cost to validate demand from a non-paid channel. (c) Add retargeting ads for visitors who viewed a product page but did not preorder, to measure intent among warmer audiences.

12. Submission

This file has been saved as OniNets_ValidationExperiment.pdf and is ready to upload into Question 11 of the Validation Grant Application.